

No response.

My eyes darted around trying to find him.

He was . . . gone.

Then a guy walked past, smiled, and nodded to a point 10 metres up the footpath.

Through a crowd of people I spotted my son . . . with his pants around his ankles, peeing on a tree.

In the middle of Melbourne's financial mecca. At 8.45 am on a Wednesday. On a crowded footpath.

'What the hell are you doing?' I screamed, rushing towards him.

'Bush wee,' he replied matter-of-factly.

'Look, we aren't on the farm today. You can't just down your dacks and wee on a tree in the middle of the city!'

Finally, I came to my senses and scooped him up around his waist.

However, he responded like every two-year-old does when they're in trouble:

He went limp.

So, I've now got him under my arm—with his pants around his ankles—and he's still weeing.

Kind of like a pop-up sprinkler.

There I stood—in the peak morning shuffle, with office workers awkwardly rushing past us, avoiding eye contact—negotiating with a tinkling two-year-old.

Again . . . parenting is hard enough, and I'm not going to 'should' all over you.

Other finance books for kids might assign you huge lists of things to do: check off 91 chores each week. Follow a nightly 11-step plan. Have a detailed remuneration plan (pocket money) that calculates payments based on the square metres of bedroom vacuumed.